

Environmental Education

Land Sciences

May, 2026



**SE
TU**

Ollscoil
Teicneolaíochta
an Oirdheiscirt

South East
Technological
University

Short Title: Environmental Education
Faculty Science and Computing
Department Land Sciences
Cluster Horticulture
Author UMCDERMOTT
Credits 5

Level: Advanced

Description of Module / Aims

This module will provide students with the necessary skills to teach people about the natural environment using interactive, informal learning activities and materials. These people may be groups or individuals, school children, members of the public or other interested groups.

Programmes

EDUC -0023 BSc (Hons) in Land Management (in Horticulture) (WD_SBSHO_B)

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Indicative Content

- Identifying good guiding techniques, identifying audiences, tailoring delivery and content to groups and individuals
- Safety issues, hazard identification of any activity
- Interpretation methods and techniques
- Planning activities to meet targets, evaluating activities

Learning Outcomes

On successful completion of this module, a student will be able to:

1. Propose a range of activities to exploit and explain the natural environment.
2. Select a range of materials suitable for use on a site for educational purposes.
3. Evaluate an existing interpretative program.
4. Propose an educational/interpretative program with associated evaluation methods, for a given group.

Learning and Teaching Methods

- Lectures.
- Site visits.
- Problem-based scenarios.

Assessment Methods

	Weighing	Outcomes Assessed
Continuous Assessment	100%	
Group Project	20%	3
Project	80%	1,2,4

Assessment Criteria

- <40%:** Cannot suggest appropriate activities to use, with specific groups, unable to evaluate activities, cannot develop new material, cannot plan activities.
- 40%-49%:** Can suggest some appropriate activities and can modify existing activities has poor evaluation skills but can recognise key issues with activities, has poor planning skills, has problems selecting appropriate evaluation method.
- 50%-59%:** Can suggest several activities, can develop new activities, has competent evaluation skills, has good planning skills, can suggest several basic evaluation methods.
- 60%-69%:** Can suggest a range of activities, can develop new activities, has good evaluation skills recognising subtleties of different approaches. Has good planning skills and can select appropriate evaluation methods.
- 70%-100%:** Can suggest a wide range of activities, can develop new activities, has excellent evaluation skills recognising subtleties of different approaches and has developed self critical awareness. Has good planning skills and can develop and select appropriate evaluation methods.

Learning Modes

Learning Mode	F/T Hours	P/T Hours
Lecture	36	
Field Trips	12	
Independent Learning	87	

Essential Material

- Ham, S.H. _Interpretation-Making a Difference on Purpose_. US: Fulcrum, 2013.

Supplementary Material

- Diamond, J. _Practical Evaluation Guide: Tools for Museums and Other Informal Educational Settings_. US: Altmira, 1999.
- Ham, S.H. _Environmental Interpretation: A Practical Guide for People With Big Ideas and Small Budgets_. US: Fulcrum, 1992.
- Serrell, B. _Exhibit Labels: An Interpretive Approach_. 2nd ed. Maryland , US: Rowman & Littlefield Publishers, 2015.

Requested Resources

- Lecture Room: Loose Seated